

PREMISE DELTA v0.6 (THE TRUSTING FORGERY, FOURTH CUT): FABLE ATTACK ·

2026-09-11

Fresh Fable agent, given only four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.6-2026-09-11.md and its own six-front prompt; told to attack the answers in sections 8 to 10. Filed verbatim. GPT's independent attack on the same text goes beside it when Stephen runs it; the disposition follows; Stephen rules. Verdict: REWORK, high confidence; the driver is the missing book on the table at meeting one ("It'll be in her book"); the device itself again not attacked.

REVIEW OF PREMISE DELTA v0.6, THE TRUSTING FORGERY, FOURTH CUT

Reviewer: second adversary, independent of ChatGPT. I have read only the delta and take sections 8 to 10 as the complete record of what has been found and answered.

FRONT 1. Brad's candour.

Strongest objection. The candour answers the wrong question. A table looking for a liar is not the table the delta has built; the delta has built a table looking for the person who was in her house, and the letter has told that table that the person had a reason. Brad's confession at Day 19 removes the suspicion that he concealed a debt. It does nothing to the debt. After he speaks the room holds, in this order: the only money motive in the room, named by Margo and confirmed by him; the only lie to the four that Violet's own hand records, and it is his (the forged letter's third bare fact is "Brad told us a wedding in the spring and ran a marathon"); the thinnest alibi of the four, "at home, on foot, alone"; and a number, "about half," that he set himself. Section 12 states that "the letter's odd things are about someone else." That is false on the delta's own text: one of the three is about Brad, and it is the one that shows him lying to them. Ruby's Day 33 rule, "Vi didn't write down things that didn't bother her," cuts the same way against the marathon as against the ashes, and Ruby holds the marathon herself.

The line, and who says it. It is not an accusation, it is a reflex, and it belongs to Margo at Day 19 the moment Brad says "about half": "It'll be in her book." Everyone at that table knows Violet wrote everything down; the room's whole method rests on it. Margo, who advised against the loan and handed over Violet's business books on Day 8, has known for eleven days that the private loan book was not among them. She said so to the sister with a shrug. She cannot hear "about half repaid in cash" from the debtor and not think of the record, and the record is gone from a locked house on the night the lender died. If Margo does not say it, Ruby, who drives, says it a different way: "How much is half, Brad? She'll have written it down." Either line puts the missing book on the table at meeting one. The delta positions Margo's reading at Day 45 to 53, triggered by the accountant's call, but she holds both halves of it on Day 19. The interval is authored.

Severity: fatal to the landing on Liam as written; serious for the premise if the landing can be rebuilt.

What would have to be true: the room does not know Violet kept a debt book (but section 2 and Ruby's Day 33 line establish the opposite), or Margo does not know it is missing until Day 45 (but Day 8 is fixed in section 5),

or Liam's three items are written so that they outweigh a money motive, a recorded lie and a vanished ledger. Section 12 concedes this last with "Yes, if the table is written." An objection that survives only if the prose carries it is not answered in the premise.

FRONT 2. Margo's reading.

Strongest objection. "A number nobody can test" is not true, and Margo is the person who knows it is not true. Brad's claim is that he paid Violet roughly half the van money in cash between October and Day 0, and that Violet was calling it in to pay a lawyer. Cash paid to a woman who needed it for a lawyer's bill goes to one of three places: her bank, the lawyer, or a drawer in her house. Violet's business books were in Margo's hands until Day 8. The sister's accountant holds Violet's statements. Violet's solicitor knows whether he was paid this autumn and how. The house was inventoried by the estate. Her earliest competent action after Day 50 is a question she can ask on the same telephone call the delta already gives her: did any of that cash arrive anywhere. If it did, Brad told the truth, the lock dissolves, and Margo's silence has no object. If it did not, Margo holds a proven lie about money from the man who owed it, told at a table hunting a liar, beside a ledger that vanished the night the lender died. That is not "an absence"; that is a false statement of account, and an accountant takes it to the estate or to Del the same week. Her second competent action is cheaper still: she tells Liam. The delta's reason she cannot take it anywhere, that "the man it points at is the one arguing for the man the room has chosen," is a reason she would doubt herself. It is not a reason to let the room convict a man she believes is innocent when she holds the only fact that points elsewhere.

On the silence. Brad can read it, but not for the reason the delta gives. Section 5 says he "has read her true letter, knows exactly what Margo knew and when." The true letter contains "nothing about money" by section 3's own account, so it tells him nothing about Margo and the debt. What he actually has is the sequence: Margo listed the calling-in on Day 19, the estate wrote to him, Margo went quiet. That is enough for a man already packed to read a look and go. The delta should stop claiming the letter does the work; the sequence does.

Severity: serious. The lock is load-bearing and the delta has not closed the test that Margo's own profession hands her.

What would have to be true: Violet kept the cash in the house and it was never banked, the solicitor was not paid, and the estate's inventory found no cash, so that the absence proves nothing in any direction. The delta must say so, and must say why Brad's cash trail from a boat-name business in the same weeks is equally dark.

FRONT 3. One glass and her habits.

Strongest objection. The habit does not close the pool; it closes it to people she had known for years, and the delta itself names six of them who are not the four. In the three weeks before she died Violet carried the panel to the café, the cinema and two other signwriters, all people whose judgement of a hand she trusted, all people she had known long enough to ask. She pays the market manager a year ahead in cash with no receipt: nobody does that with a stranger. The boat owner knows her store door on sight. Section 5 says the audit took one evening "because her life was small enough," and section 2 says she spent her last month showing a gilded board round the trade. Both cannot be true in the same town. Chapter 7 relies on "the panel the town saw her carry." If the town saw it, one of the four heard of it, and the woman who asked the trade "whose hand is this" three weeks before her death, and wrote a letter about strangers in her house that never mentions it, is the

tampering thought delivered to Ruby's table on Day 15. The v0.5 finding 8 answer, "nobody suspects the letter; no tampering hypothesis," fails on Day 14 at 21:00, in the delta's own text, when Ruby names a line that did not sound like Vi. The delta plants the doubt in the character who drives and then requires her not to follow it for three hundred days.

On the police. The reason they could not weigh the habit and the room could is sound in principle: the habit is lived knowledge, not evidence. But the delta undercuts its own witness. Number 14 saw "a man's back and nothing in his hands" while the book was "in the rucksack he brought for it." A man seen from behind carrying a rucksack is a man with a rucksack; that is the one thing a back shows. Told to the police on Day 1 and to Liam at the funeral, it is a descriptor, and in a town this size it narrows four men to the one who walks.

Severity: serious. The one-evening audit is asserted against the delta's own list of people Violet trusted, and the witness line is written to protect Brad in a way the witness would not.

What would have to be true: none of the trade had seen the panel by Day 15 in any way that reached the four, which contradicts chapter 7's "the town saw her carry it"; or the four heard and had a reason not to weigh it that the delta states. And the rucksack must be dealt with: either Number 14 saw it and said so, with consequences, or he did not carry one.

FRONT 4. The store and the sister.

Strongest objection. The path is not the books; it is the landlord. The market manager has a dead tenant. Violet's funeral is over by Day 11 (the envelopes go out after it on Day 12) and the sheds are worked from first light by people who knew her store door by sight. A market manager whose tenant has died, with her hull kit's bay paid to next year and a padlock he did not fit on the door, has an ordinary reason to speak to the family, if only to ask what is to be done with the bay and to cover himself for what is inside it. On Day 82 he confirms the tenancy readily enough for the sister to have the padlock cut. The delta needs him silent from Day 1 to Day 82 and gives him no motive for it. There is a motive available, undeclared cash, but the delta does not state it, and silence for that reason has its own consequences when the sister turns up with bolt cutters.

I cannot find a person with a right to the estate who learns before Day 14 by a route the delta has left open; the solicitor holds envelopes not addresses of stores, the key cutter has no reason, the police never went to the sheds. The landlord is the only door and it is unlatched.

Severity: serious, and answerable.

What would have to be true: the market manager keeps cash tenancies dark as a matter of habit and has a stated reason to want the bay unmentioned to an estranged sister with her own solicitor. One sentence in section 2 would do it; it is not there.

FRONT 5. The showing at the store door.

Strongest objection. On Day -19 Brad learns three things in one minute: she knows someone has been in her roof, she is asking the trade about it by name, and she has begun locking things away "for after." A competent man who has been entering her house with the spare for the tin and the roof does one thing before he kills her: he finds out what she has written down, because she has just told him she writes things down and locks them up. He has nineteen days, a key, and a habit of her house. If he reads the book before Day 0, the twenty minutes on the landing are unnecessary and the plan is made in knowledge, which is better for the story and

worse for the delta's claim that Day 0 was a visit "about the money." If he does not read it, the entire Day 0 to Day 14 machine depends on Violet falling with the one book in her hand that tells him everything, which is the author's luck.

Does it move Day 0. Not earlier; nothing he learns at the store door gives him a reason to hurry. It moves it later, or moves it off altogether, for a man whose method is that nothing is ever visibly wrong. Two signwriters and the café now remember Violet asking who gilded a panel she did not make. Killing her within three weeks of that question makes the question the one the trade asks at her funeral. The competent choice is to let the question go cold. The delta says the motive does not change, and I do not reopen it, but it has not stated what forces Day 0 to fall inside the window in which the trade's memory is fresh. The calling-in has no stated deadline. The tin's failure is not something the delta shows him learning.

Severity: serious for the fourteen-day mechanism's dependence on luck at the landing; serious for the date.

What would have to be true: a forcing date on the money (a lawyer's bill with a day on it that Brad knows), and either Brad reads the book before Day 0 and the delta owns it, or the delta states why a man with the spare and nineteen days does not.

FRONT 6. The whole.

The earliest competent action by any person that ends the episode before its time is on Day 19 at Ruby's table, and it is Margo's, by reflex: "It'll be in her book." From that sentence the room holds within a minute that the one record of Brad's debt left a locked house on the night the lender died, that the debtor sat down and set his own number, and that the debtor is the man Violet's own hand says lied to them about where he was. The room does not land on Liam by Day 47. It lands on Brad by Day 19, and it has no more to show Del than Margo has on Day 53, so the police branch looks the same; but Brad reads that room as surely as he reads Margo's silence, Kestrel Head comes six weeks early, and there is no Liam beat, no Margo lock, and no chapter 7 turn, because the room already turned.

Two earlier actions are available and are held back only by fiat. On Day 14 at 21:00 Ruby says a line does not sound like Vi; the question "when did your letter come" is one sentence away, and Brad's is in his pocket with a box number on it. The delta's v0.5 answer to finding 8 does not survive the doubt the delta itself gives Ruby. On Day 15 the one-evening audit finds nobody only if none of the four has heard the town's talk about a woman carrying a gilded board round the trade. Two smaller things should be fixed in the same pass: Violet believes her spare has been used and leaves it in the meter box while fitting a closed-shackle marine padlock to a boat store, which is out of character for the woman section 2 describes and exists to give Liam his Day 15 line; and chapter 7 has Ruby hand Ally "the envelope" with a covering slip that shows four addresses and a box number, which only works if the solicitor sent one slip listing all four, and the delta should say he did.

VERDICT: REWORK. Confidence high. The single finding that drives it is the book at meeting one. The delta made the debt public, made the ledger the only record, put its absence in Margo's knowledge on Day 8, and then seated Margo at a table on Day 19 where the debtor names his own balance. Those four facts are all the delta's own, all built in this round or held from the last, and together they put the missing book on the table five weeks before the delta needs it, aimed at the wrong man for the story and the right man for the murder. Fronts 2 and 3 are the same failure seen from Margo's profession and from Ruby's doubt: the delta has given its two most competent characters the facts and then asked them not to be competent until Day 47.

The device itself, a forged trust rather than a forged fear, is still the best thing in this delta and I do not attack it. The fourth cut fails on the table, not on the letter.